

Lecture 12

Time Series Analysis I

STAT 8020 Statistical Methods II

Whitney Huang
Clemson University

Agenda

Background

Time Series Models

A Case Study

1 Background

2 Time Series Models

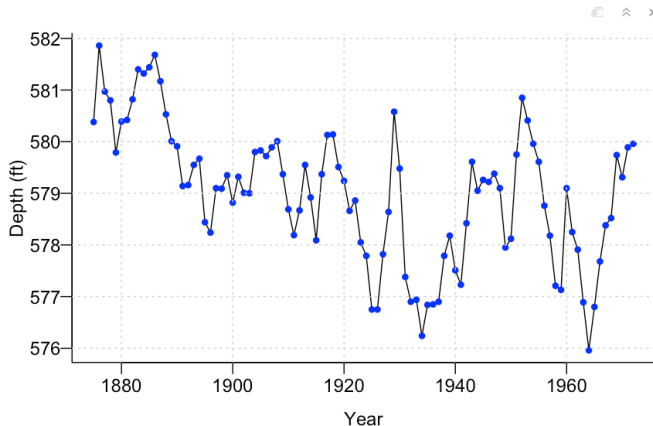
3 A Case Study

Level of Lake Huron 1875–1972

Annual measurements of the level of Lake Huron in feet.

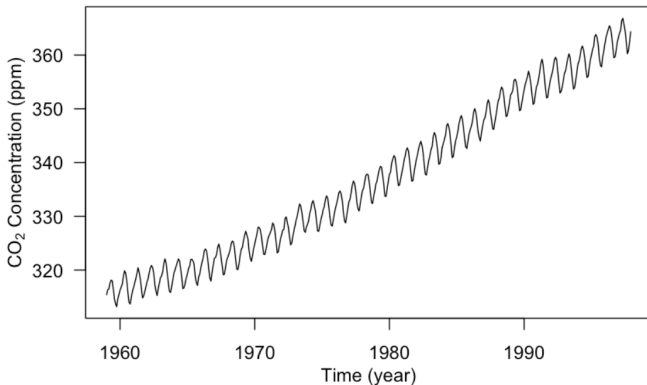
[Source: [Brockwell & Davis, 1991](#)]

```
## {r}
par(mar = c(3.2, 3.2, 0.5, 0.5), mgp = c(2, 0.5, 0), bty = "L")
data(LakeHuron)
plot(LakeHuron, ylab = "Depth (ft)", xlab = "Year", las = 1)
points(LakeHuron, cex = 0.8, col = "blue", pch = 16)
grid()
##
```



Mauna Loa Atmospheric CO₂ Concentration

Monthly atmospheric CO₂ at Mauna Loa Observatory [Source: Keeling & Whorf (SIO)]

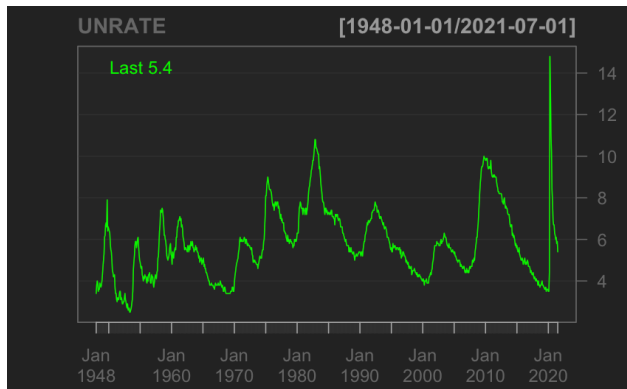


Observation

The series exhibits both a long-term increasing trend and strong yearly seasonality

US Unemployment Rate 1948 Jan. – 2021 July

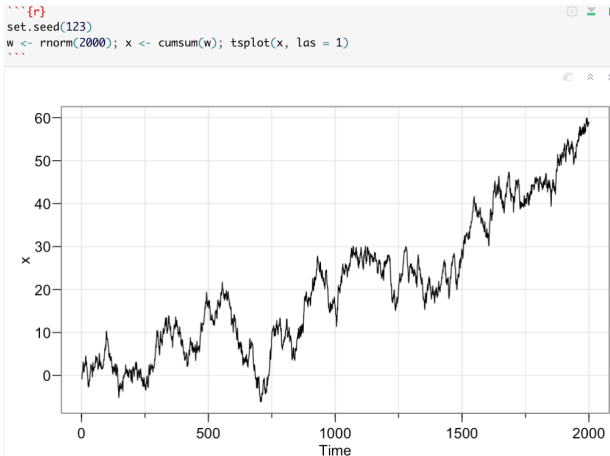
[Source: St. Louis Federal Reserve Bank's FRED system]



Observation

The series shows recurring economic cycles, along with occasional extreme spikes such as during COVID-19

A Simulated Time Series



Observation

The fluctuations appear to become larger over time

- A **time series** is a sequence of observations $\{Y_t, t \in T\}$ recorded over time.
 - $T = \{0, 1, 2, \dots, T\} \subset \mathbb{Z} \Rightarrow$ **discrete-time time series**
 - $T = [0, T] \subset \mathbb{R} \Rightarrow$ **continuous-time time series**
- Discrete-time series may be naturally discrete or obtained from an underlying continuous process through:
 - **Sampling** (e.g., instantaneous wind speed)
 - **Aggregation** (e.g., daily precipitation totals)
 - **Extrema** (e.g., daily maximum temperature)
- In this course, we focus on **discrete-time real-valued** time series ($Y_t \in \mathbb{R}$).

Unlike independent data, nearby observations in a time series are often correlated

- Start with a **time series plot**, i.e., to plot y_t versus t
 - ▶ Lake Huron Time Series
- Look at the following:
 - Are there abrupt changes?
 - Are there “outliers”?
 - Is there a need to transform the data?
- Examine the **trend**, **seasonal components**, and the “noise” term

Component	Meaning	Example
Trend (μ_t)	Long-term smooth movement in the series	Global warming
Seasonality (s_t)	Repeating pattern or cycle over time	Monthly electricity demand
Noise (η_t)	Random fluctuations not explained by trend or seasonality	Day-to-day variability

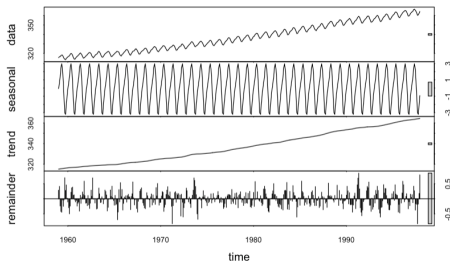
Takeaway

Many time series can be viewed as a combination of trend, seasonality, and random noise

Decomposing Time Series into Trend, Seasonality, and Noise

- Additive model:

$$y_t = \mu_t + s_t + \eta_t, \quad t = 1, \dots, T$$



- Multiplicative model:

$$y_t = \mu_t s_t \eta_t, \quad t = 1, \dots, T$$

If $y_t > 0$, taking logs gives an additive form:

$$\log y_t = \log \mu_t + \log s_t + \log \eta_t$$

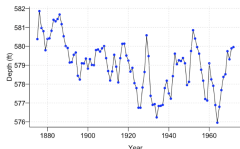
Many time series models focus on modeling the remaining noise process after removing trend and seasonality

Modeling

Find a **statistical model** that explains the observed data over time

Example: Model Lake Huron depths exhibiting

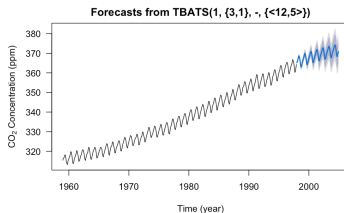
- temporal correlation
- long-term decline



Supports further inference such as: **Is there evidence of a decreasing trend?**

Forecasting

Use observed data to predict future values.



Common applications:

- weather
- finance
- sales
- energy demand

Background

Time Series Models

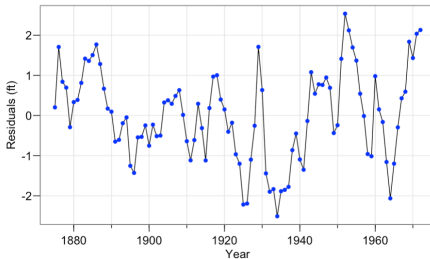
A Case Study

- **Adjustment:** an example would be [seasonal adjustment](#), where the seasonal component is estimated and then removed in order to better understand the underlying trend
- **Simulation:** use a time series model (which adequately describes a physical process) as a surrogate to *simulate repeatedly in order to approximate how the physical process behaves*
- **Control:** adjust various [input \(control\)](#) parameters so that the time series fits closer to a given standard (many examples from statistical quality control)

Time Series Models

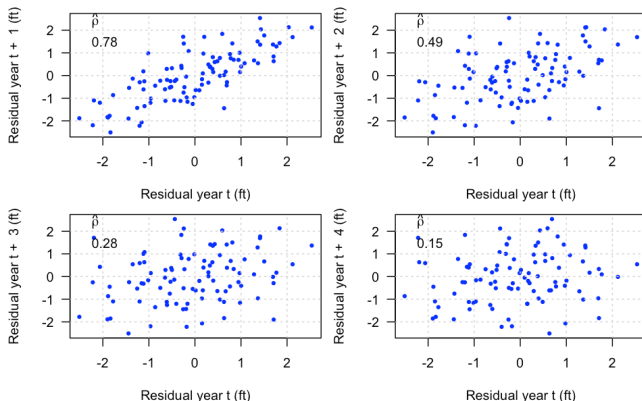
Lake Huron Time Series

- **Time series analysis** is the area of statistics which deals with the analysis of **dependency** between observations over time (typically $\{\eta_t\}$)
- Some key features of the Lake Huron time series:
 - ▶ Lake Huron Time Series
 - decreasing trend
 - some “random” fluctuations around the decreasing trend
- We extract the “noise” component by assuming a linear trend



Exploring the Temporal Dependence Structure of $\{\eta_t\}$

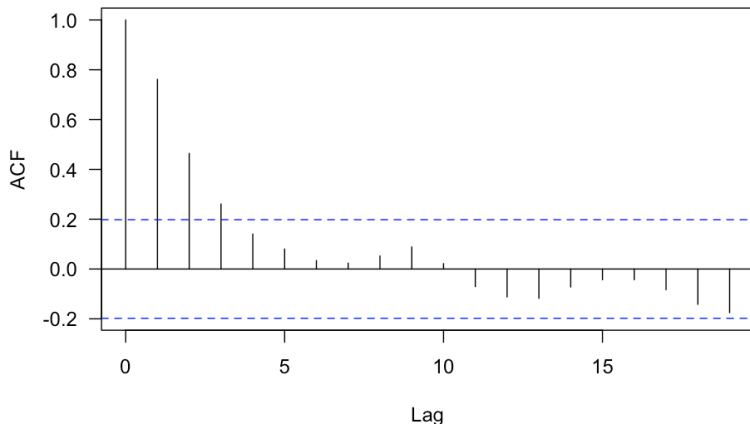
$\{\eta_t\}$ exhibit some temporal dependence structure, that is, the nearby (in time) values tend to be more alike than those far part values. To see this, let's make a few time lag plots



Positive slope in lag plots suggests positive temporal correlation

Further Exploration of the Temporal Dependence Structure

Let's plot the correlation as a function of the time lag



Positive autocorrelation persists across lags, but weakens as the lag increases. We will use this information to suggest an appropriate model

- A **time series model** is a probabilistic model for $\{Y_t : t \in T\}$ that describes ways that the series data $\{y_t\}$ could have been generated
- Will try to keep our models for $\{Y_t\}$ simple by assuming **stationarity** $\Rightarrow$ characteristic of the distribution of $\{Y_t\}$ does not depend on the time points, only on the “time lag”

We will focus on **stationarity** in **means** and **autocovariances**

- While most time series are not stationary, one either remove or model the non-stationary parts (e.g., de-trend or de-seasonalization) so that we are only left with a stationary component $\{\eta_t\}$.

A **time series model** is a probabilistic model for $\{Y_t : t \in T\}$, describing how the observed series $\{y_t\}$ could have been generated

- To keep models mathematically tractable, we often assume **stationarity** $\Rightarrow$ distributional properties depend on lag, not on time itself

In this course, we mainly focus on the weaker notion of stationarity based on:

- constant means
 - autocovariances depending only on lag
- Most real-world time series are not stationary

Common practice:

remove or model trends/seasonality so that the remaining component $\{\eta_t\}$ is approximately stationary

- The **mean function** of $\{\eta_t\}$ is

$$\mu_t = E[\eta_t], \quad t \in T$$

- The **autocovariance function** of $\{\eta_t\}$ is

$$\gamma(t, t') = \text{Cov}(\eta_t, \eta_{t'}) = E[(\eta_t - \mu_t)(\eta_{t'} - \mu_{t'})], \quad t, t' \in T$$

- When $t = t'$,

$$\gamma(t, t) = \text{Var}(\eta_t) = \sigma_t^2,$$

which is the **variance function** of $\{\eta_t\}$.

The autocorrelation function (ACF) of $\{\eta_t\}$ is

$$\rho(t, t') = \text{Corr}(\eta_t, \eta_{t'}) = \frac{\gamma(t, t')}{\sqrt{\gamma(t, t)\gamma(t', t')}}}$$

It measures the strength of linear association between η_t and $\eta_{t'}$

Properties:

- 1 $-1 \leq \rho(t, t') \leq 1, \quad t, t' \in T$
- 2 $\rho(t, t') = \rho(t', t), \quad \forall t, t' \in T; \rho(t, t) = 1, \quad \forall t \in T$
- 3 $\rho(t, t')$ is a non-negative definite function

Partial autocorrelation function (PACF) is a conditional correlation, i.e., the correlation at two time points given the information at all other time points

Weakly Stationary Processes

To simplify modeling, we often assume **weak stationarity**, meaning that the distributional properties depend only on the **time lag**

Weak stationarity requires:

- Constant mean:

$$E[\eta_t] = \mu, \quad \forall t \in T$$

- Autocovariance depends only on lag:

$$\text{Cov}(\eta_t, \eta_{t'}) = \gamma(t' - t) = \gamma(h)$$

Equivalently,

$$\text{Cov}(\eta_t, \eta_{t'}) = \text{Cov}(\eta_{t+s}, \eta_{t'+s})$$

Under stationarity, the ACF depends only on lag:

$$\rho(h) = \frac{\gamma(h)}{\gamma(0)}$$

Autoregressive Moving Average (ARMA) Models

Let $\{Z_t\}$ be independent and identical random variables that follow $N(0, \sigma^2)$

- Moving Average Processes (MA(q)):

$$\eta_t = Z_t + \theta_1 Z_{t-1} + \theta_2 Z_{t-2} \cdots + \theta_q Z_{t-q}$$

⇒ Current values depend on previous random shocks

Autoregressive Moving Average (ARMA) Models

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- Autoregressive Processes (AR(p)):

$$\eta_t = \phi_1 \eta_{t-1} + \phi_2 \eta_{t-2} + \cdots + \phi_p \eta_{t-p} + Z_t$$

⇒ Current values depend on previous observations

Autoregressive Moving Average (ARMA) Models

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⇒ Current values depend on previous observations

- Autoregressive Moving Average Processes ARMA(p,q):

$$\eta_t = \phi_1 \eta_{t-1} + \phi_2 \eta_{t-2} + \cdots + \phi_p \eta_{t-p} + Z_t + \theta_1 Z_{t-1} + \theta_2 Z_{t-2} + \cdots + \theta_q Z_{t-q}$$

⇒ Combines dependence on past observations and past shocks

Model	Depends On
AR	Past observations
MA	Past errors/shocks
ARMA	Both

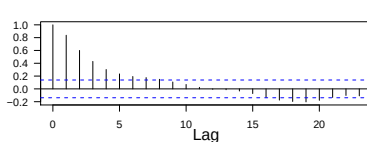
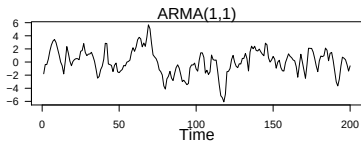
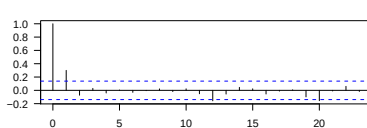
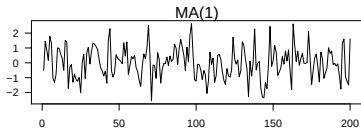
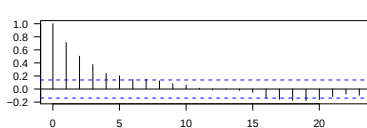
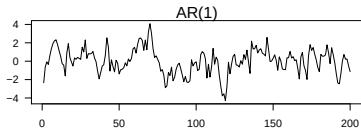
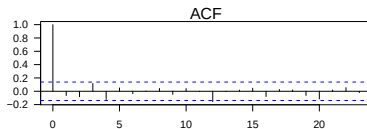
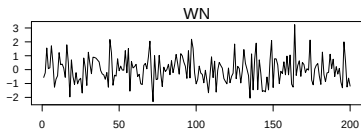
Examples:

$$\text{AR}(1): \eta_t = \phi\eta_{t-1} + Z_t$$

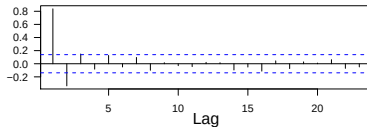
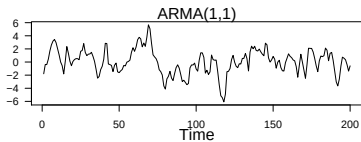
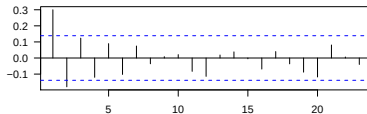
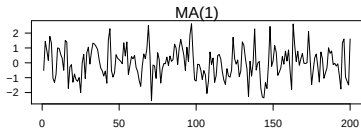
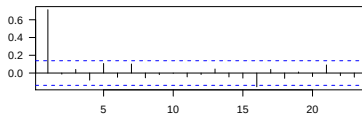
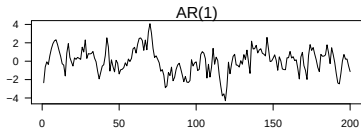
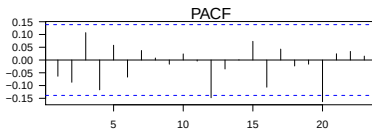
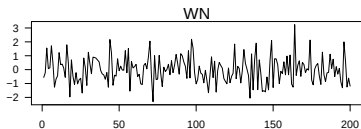
$$\text{MA}(1): \eta_t = Z_t + \theta Z_{t-1}$$

$$\text{ARMA}(1,1): \eta_t = \phi\eta_{t-1} + Z_t + \theta Z_{t-1}$$

ACF Plots



PACF Plots



Identification of ARMA Models using ACF/PACF Plots

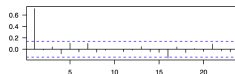
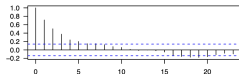
Use the ACF and PACF together to identify candidate models.
The following table gives some rough guidelines.

	ACF	PACF
$AR(p)$	Tails off	Cuts off after lag p
$MA(q)$	Cuts off after lag q	Tails off
$ARMA(p, q)$	Tails off	Tails off

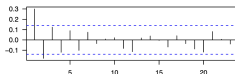
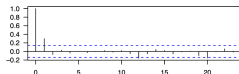
ACF

PACF

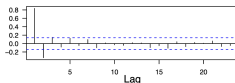
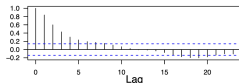
AR(1)



MA(1)



ARMA(1, 1)



Remark: ACF/PACF identification is often heuristic and mainly used to suggest initial candidate models; **criteria such as AIC or BIC are then used for formal model selection**

Model Diagnostics: Ljung-Box Test [Ljung and Box, 1978]

We wish to test:

$H_0 : \{e_1, e_2, \dots, e_T\}$ is an i.i.d. noise sequence $\Rightarrow$ model adequate

$H_1 : H_0$ is false $\Rightarrow$ model not good,

where $\{e_t\}$ are the residuals after fitting a model to $\{\eta_t\}$

Test statistic:

$$Q_{LB} = T(T-2) \sum_{h=1}^{\text{lag}} \frac{\hat{\rho}_{\hat{e}}^2(h)}{T-h} \stackrel{H_0}{\approx} \chi_k^2,$$

where T is the sample size, $\hat{\rho}_{\hat{e}}(h)$ is the sample ACF at lag h , applied to the residuals of a fitted ARIMA model. The degrees of freedom $k = \text{Lag} - p - q$.

Ljung-Box test can be carried out in R using the function

`Box.test`

Lake Huron Case Study



Source: <https://www.worldatlas.com/articles/what-states-border-lake-huron.html>

- Detrending
- Model fitting and selection
- Forecasting

Annual Measurements of the Level of Lake Huron

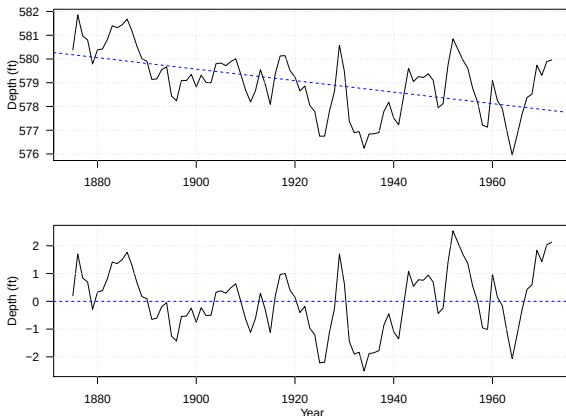


There seems to be a decreasing trend $\Rightarrow$ need to estimate the trend to get the detrended series

Plots of the Trend and Residuals

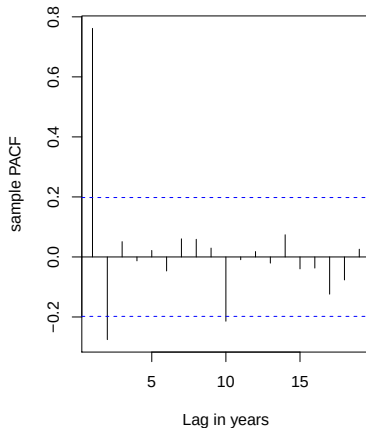
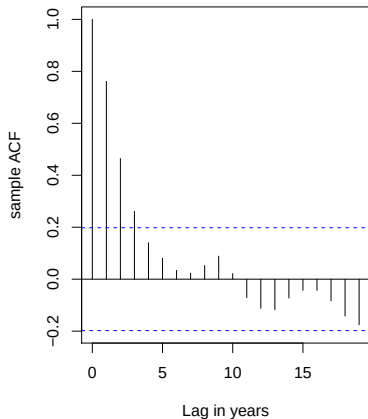
$$y_t = \underbrace{\mu_t}_{\text{trend}} + \underbrace{\eta_t}_{\text{residual}}$$

where we **assume** $\mu_t = \alpha + \beta t$, i.e., a linear trend in time



ACF and PACF Plots

- Tapering pattern in ACF $\Rightarrow$ need to include AR terms
- Significant PACF values at the first 2 lags $\Rightarrow$ an AR(2) candidate model



Fitting an AR(2) to the Detrended Time Series

```
> (ar2.model <- arima(deTrend, order = c(2, 0, 0), method = "ML"))
```

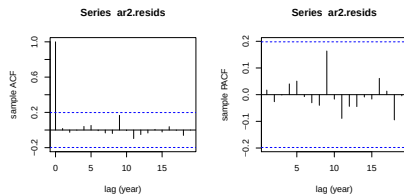
Call:

```
arima(x = deTrend, order = c(2, 0, 0), method = "ML")
```

Coefficients:

	ar1	ar2	intercept
	1.0047	-0.2919	0.0197
s.e.	0.0977	0.1004	0.2350

σ^2 estimated as 0.4571: log likelihood = -101.25, aic = 210.5



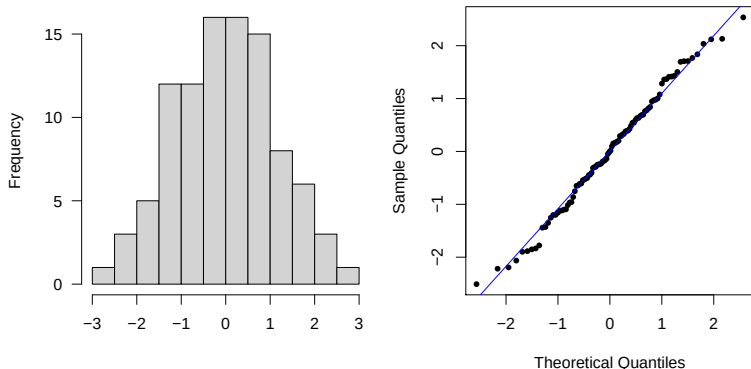
```
> Box.test(ar2.resids, lag = 5, fitdf = 2, type = "Ljung-Box")
```

Box-Ljung test

data: ar2.resids

X-squared = 0.55962, df = 3, p-value = 0.9056

Assessing Normality Assumption for η_t



- **Histogram:** To compare the shape of the distribution of residuals with the bell-shaped normal density curve
- **Q-Q plot:** To compare the quantiles of the residual distribution to the quantiles of a normal distribution

Model Selection via AIC

We can conduct model selection by using, for example, AIC

```
> auto.arima(deTrend, trace = T)
```

```
ARIMA(2,0,2) with non-zero mean : 215.0455
ARIMA(0,0,0) with non-zero mean : 304.222
ARIMA(1,0,0) with non-zero mean : 216.8388
ARIMA(0,0,1) with non-zero mean : 235.4585
ARIMA(0,0,0) with zero mean      : 302.1373
ARIMA(1,0,2) with non-zero mean : 212.7747
ARIMA(0,0,2) with non-zero mean : 218.2478
ARIMA(1,0,1) with non-zero mean : 210.9477
ARIMA(2,0,1) with non-zero mean : 212.8306
ARIMA(2,0,0) with non-zero mean : 210.9333
ARIMA(3,0,0) with non-zero mean : 212.7787
ARIMA(3,0,1) with non-zero mean : Inf
ARIMA(2,0,0) with zero mean      : 208.7655
ARIMA(1,0,0) with zero mean      : 214.7735
ARIMA(3,0,0) with zero mean      : 210.569
ARIMA(2,0,1) with zero mean      : 210.6186
ARIMA(1,0,1) with zero mean      : 208.7891
ARIMA(3,0,1) with zero mean      : Inf
```

Best model: ARIMA(2,0,0) with zero mean

Smaller AIC values indicate better tradeoff between model fit and model complexity

Fitting Linear Trend and ARMA in One Step

```
> (fit <- Arima(LakeHuron, order = c(2, 0, 0), include.drift = T))
```

Series: LakeHuron

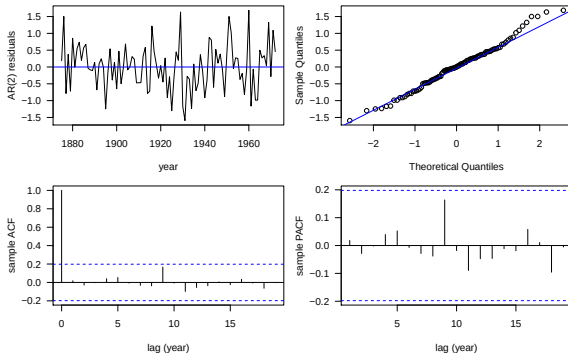
ARIMA(2,0,0) with drift

Coefficients:

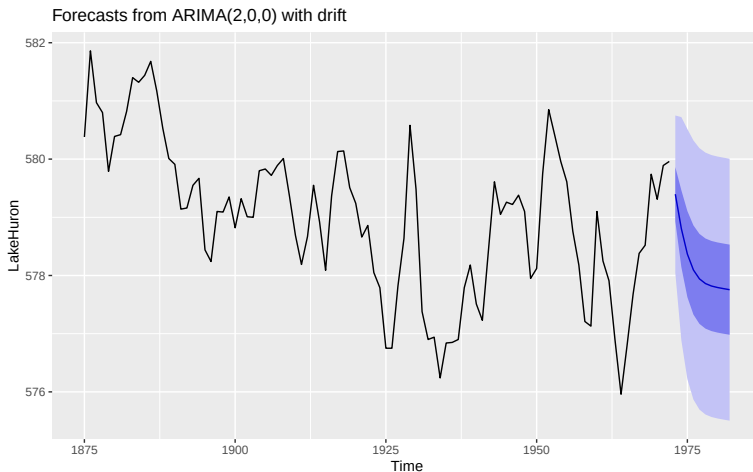
	ar1	ar2	intercept	drift
	1.0048	-0.2913	580.0915	-0.0216
s.e.	0.0976	0.1004	0.4636	0.0081

$\sigma^2 = 0.476$: log likelihood = -101.2

AIC=212.4 AICc=213.05 BIC=225.32



10-Year-Ahead Forecasts



Prediction intervals widen over time because uncertainty accumulates further into the future

Summary

These slides cover:

- Basic concepts of time series analysis
- A widely used class of models: **ARMA**
- ARMA model identification, estimation/prediction, inference

R functions to know:

- `acf` and `pacf` for identifying candidate models
- `arima` and `Arima` (under the package `forecast`) for model fitting
- `auto.arima` for model selection
- `Box.test` for testing model adequacy
- `forecast` (under the package `forecast`) for generating forecasts and prediction intervals